

OSDHack 2026

Participant Rulebook

Build on-device AI that is faster, lighter, more private, and open source.

Theme	On Device AI
Format	Online hackathon
Dates	10 July 2026, 6:00 PM IST to 15 July 2026, 6:00 PM IST
Hosted on	Unstop
Official support	Discord and Unstop
Organizer	Open Source Developers Community (OSDC)



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1 Read This First

Welcome to **OSDHack 2026**, an online open-source hackathon organized by **Open Source Developers Community (OSDC)**.

The hackathon is built around **On Device AI**. Your goal is to build a project where the main AI feature runs locally on a phone, laptop, desktop, browser, edge device, or embedded system.

Quick Summary

- Build an open-source project around **On Device AI**.
- Register and submit through **Unstop**.
- Join **Discord** for announcements, support, resources, and mini-event details.
- Build during the official hackathon window only.
- Submit a public repository, README, demo video, and screenshots before the deadline.

1.1 Event Timeline

All times are in **Indian Standard Time (IST)**.

Hackathon starts	10 July 2026, 6:00 PM IST
Hackathon ends	15 July 2026, 6:00 PM IST
Final submission deadline	15 July 2026, 6:00 PM IST
Evaluation period	To be announced
Results announcement	To be announced

1.2 Who Can Participate

OSDHack 2026 is open to everyone. Students, professionals, beginners, developers, designers, researchers, hobbyists, and open-source enthusiasts are welcome.

Participants from different colleges, countries, organizations, or specializations may team up.

1.3 Team Rules

- Team size: **1 to 4 members**.
- Solo participation is allowed.
- Each participant can be part of only one team.
- A participant cannot submit multiple projects through different teams.

2 Main Hackathon Rules

2.1 Theme: On Device AI

Your project should focus on AI that runs locally.

You can build around:

- Local AI models
- Browser-based AI
- Mobile on-device AI
- Desktop or laptop AI tools
- Edge or embedded AI
- Offline-first AI apps
- Privacy-focused AI tools
- Lightweight local inference

Cloud services are allowed for support features such as hosting, authentication, storage, databases, deployment, analytics, or non-core backend features.

Important: The main AI functionality should run on-device, locally, in-browser, on edge, or on embedded hardware. Cloud support is fine; the core AI magic should happen locally.

2.2 Development Window

Projects must be built during the official hackathon period:

10 July 2026, 6:00 PM IST to 15 July 2026, 6:00 PM IST

Only work committed before **15 July 2026, 6:00 PM IST** will be considered for judging. Later commits may remain in the repository, but they will not be evaluated.

Pre-built complete projects should not be submitted as hackathon work.

2.3 Open-Source Requirement

OSDHack 2026 is an open-source hackathon.

- Your project must be fully open source.
- Your project must use an **OSI-compliant open-source license**.
- Your repository is expected to include a visible `LICENSE` file.
- Your repository must be public and accessible at final submission.
- You may use GitHub, GitLab, Codeberg, Bitbucket, or any other public Git hosting platform.

You may use open-source libraries, frameworks, models, datasets, templates, and tools as long as you follow their licenses and give attribution where required.

3 Submission Instructions

Final submissions must be made on **Unstop** before the deadline.

Your submission should make it easy for judges to understand:

- What you built
- Why it matters
- How it works
- How it uses On Device AI
- How others can run or try it

3.1 Required Submission Items

Repository link	Public Git repository containing your source code and project files.
README	Clear explanation of the project, setup, usage, tech stack, and On Device AI usage.
Demo video	A short walkthrough showing the project in action.
Screenshots	Images showing the interface, workflow, results, or important project screens.

3.2 README Checklist

A good README should include:

- Project name
- Short description
- Problem statement
- Solution overview
- On Device AI explanation
- Tech stack
- Setup instructions
- Usage instructions
- Demo video link
- Screenshots
- License information
- Known limitations or future scope

A simple, clear README is better than a long confusing one.

3.3 Demo Video Guidelines

Recommended length: **2 to 5 minutes**. There is no strict limit, but short and clear is best.

The video should show:

- What the project does
- The problem it solves
- Main features
- How the On Device AI part works
- A quick walkthrough of the app, tool, or prototype

Upload the video to YouTube, Google Drive, Loom, Vimeo, or any other publicly accessible platform. Make sure the link works without special permissions.

3.4 Screenshots

Submit screenshots that help judges quickly understand your project. They can show the main interface, core features, AI output, workflow, results, or important project screens.

Screenshots may be included in the README, Unstop submission, or both.

4 Prizes

Main Hackathon Prizes

Winner	₹7,000 cash + 2-year CodeCrafters VIP membership worth \$720 + .xyz domains
1st Runner-Up	₹3,000 cash + 1-year CodeCrafters VIP membership worth \$360 + .xyz domains
2nd Runner-Up	₹2,000 cash + 6-month CodeCrafters VIP membership worth \$180 + .xyz domains

Mini-event prizes

- Capture The Flag Winner: ₹1,000 cash
- Speed Typing Winner: ₹1,000 cash
- CodeBattleships Winner: ₹1,000 cash

Judging criteria and detailed evaluation process will be shared through official communication channels.

5 Mini-Events

Mini-events are optional, separate from the main hackathon, and open to all. You do not need to submit a main hackathon project to join mini-events.

Mini-event participation does **not** affect the main hackathon score. Rules, links, updates, and results will be shared on Discord.

5.1 Capture The Flag

It is not just a game - it is a digital battlefield. Solve puzzles, crack codes, and capture flags in this mini-CTF.

Starts	12 July 2026, 5:00 PM IST
Ends	13 July 2026, 5:00 PM IST
Format	Team-based CTF
Prize	₹1,000 cash for the winner

Challenge categories may include:

- Cryptography
- Web Exploitation
- Forensics
- OSINT
- General Skills
- Miscellaneous

Rules

- Flags must be submitted in the correct format.
- Challenges may have different point values.
- The team with the highest score wins.
- Cheating, flag sharing, or attacking the event platform is not allowed.
- Detailed instructions will be shared on Discord.

5.2 Speed Typing

Put your fingers to the test. A fast-paced typing showdown where speed meets accuracy.

Session 1	12 July 2026, 12:00 PM to 1:00 PM IST
Session 2	13 July 2026, 12:00 PM to 1:00 PM IST
Finals	13 July 2026, 7:00 PM IST
Prize	₹1,000 cash for the winner

Rules

- Participants will be given random text to type.
- Both speed and accuracy count.
- Top performers from the sessions qualify for finals.
- Final ranking will be based on the event scoring system.
- Detailed instructions will be shared on Discord.

5.3 CodeBattleships

Code. Sink. Conquer. CodeBattleships combines programming challenges with the classic Battleship strategy game.

Players are matched against opponents, place their ships, and compete by solving coding challenges. Winning a coding challenge gives the player a chance to attack the opponent's board. Incorrect answers may give the opponent a free shot and may hide previously revealed cells. The match continues until all ships of one player are destroyed.

Starts	14 July 2026, 12:00 PM IST
Ends	14 July 2026, 2:00 PM IST
Format	Team registration, individual gameplay
Prize	₹1,000 cash for the winning team

How it works

- Participants register with teams.
- Players compete individually in matches.
- Each player places ships on their board.
- Players solve coding challenges during the match.
- Winning a challenge gives the player a chance to launch an attack.
- Incorrect answers may give the opponent an advantage.
- Ratings and leaderboard rankings update based on match results.
- Individual scores are combined into team scores.
- The team with the highest total score wins.

Rules

- Registration is team-based.
- Gameplay is individual.
- Team score is calculated from individual player scores.
- Detailed match rules and platform instructions will be shared on Discord.

6 Fair Play and Safety

6.1 Fair Play Rules

To keep the hackathon fun and fair:

- Build around On Device AI.
- Build during the official hackathon period.
- Keep your project open source.
- Use an OSI-compliant license.
- Keep your repository public at submission time.
- Submit all required items before the deadline.
- Respect third-party licenses and give attribution where needed.
- Do not submit copied, stolen, plagiarized, or misrepresented work.

- Do not submit harmful, illegal, abusive, or unsafe projects.
- Follow official Unstop and Discord instructions.

6.2 Disqualification Criteria

A project or participant may be disqualified for:

- Plagiarism
- Fake commits
- Pre-built complete projects
- Private or inaccessible repositories
- Missing submission items
- Inaccessible demo video
- Deadline violations
- Misrepresentation of work or ownership
- Stolen code, assets, or proprietary material
- Harmful, illegal, unsafe, or abusive content
- Violation of open-source license requirements
- Violation of Unstop, Discord, or event rules

Organizers may review issues case by case and make the final decision.

6.3 Responsible Project Guidelines

Projects must not promote or enable harm. Do not submit projects intended for malware, phishing, unauthorized surveillance, privacy invasion, harassment, abuse, illegal activity, real-world harm, exploitation, or misuse of sensitive personal data.

Security, privacy, and AI-related projects are allowed when they are built responsibly for educational, defensive, or beneficial purposes.

7 New to On Device AI?

No worries - you do not need to be an AI expert to participate.

On Device AI means the AI runs directly on the user's device instead of relying fully on a remote cloud AI service.

That device could be:

- A browser
- A laptop or desktop
- A phone
- An edge device
- An embedded board or microcontroller

You do not need expensive hardware or a powerful GPU. A simple browser-based, desktop, or phone-based project can be a strong submission.

7.1 Where Can You Start?

There is no single correct way to build an On Device AI project. Start with something small, fun, and useful.

You could build:

- A browser tool that works offline
- A local AI assistant
- A privacy-friendly productivity app
- A smart camera or detection system
- A lightweight chatbot
- A speech or audio utility

- A document helper
- A TinyML or robotics experiment
- An AI-powered accessibility tool
- A creative AI experience that runs locally

The goal is not to build the biggest model possible. Build something thoughtful, practical, creative, or fun using local AI.

7.2 Helpful Resources

These are starting points, not requirements.

Browser and Web AI	Transformers.js: https://huggingface.co/docs/transformers.js ONNX Runtime Web: https://onnxruntime.ai/docs/tutorials/web/ WebLLM: https://webllm.mlc.ai/docs/
Mobile AI	LiteRT: https://ai.google.dev/edge/litert ONNX Runtime Mobile: https://onnxruntime.ai/docs/get-started/with-mobile.html MediaPipe: https://ai.google.dev/edge/mediapipe/solutions/guide ExecuTorch: https://docs.pytorch.org/executorch/stable/index.html
Local Desktop AI	Hugging Face Models: https://huggingface.co/models ONNX Runtime: https://onnxruntime.ai/docs/ llama.cpp: https://github.com/ggml-org/llama.cpp Ollama: https://docs.ollama.com/
Edge and Embedded AI	LiteRT for Microcontrollers: https://www.tensorflow.org/lite/microcontrollers MediaPipe: https://ai.google.dev/edge/mediapipe/solutions/guide ExecuTorch: https://docs.pytorch.org/executorch/stable/index.html

7.3 Sample Tech Stacks

Web app stack: React / Vite / Next.js + Transformers.js or ONNX Runtime Web + Hugging Face models + Vercel, Netlify, or GitHub Pages.

Mobile app stack: Flutter / React Native / Kotlin / Swift + LiteRT, MediaPipe, or ONNX Runtime Mobile + local model bundled with the app.

Desktop app stack: Python / Streamlit / Gradio / Electron / Tauri + Ollama, llama.cpp, ONNX Runtime, or local Hugging Face models.

Embedded or edge stack: Raspberry Pi / Arduino-compatible board / ESP32-class board + LiteRT Micro, MediaPipe, or lightweight custom models.

8 Official Communication

The official Discord server will be the main communication space for OSDHack 2026.

Join Discord for:

Discord link: <https://discord.gg/qNcWcJXyd>

- Announcements
- Support
- Resources
- Deadline reminders
- Mini-event updates
- Clarifications
- Community interaction

Participants are responsible for checking official announcements regularly.

9 Appendices

9.1 Appendix A: Final Submission Checklist

Before submitting, make sure your project has:

- Public repository link
- Source code
- Clear README
- OSI-compliant license
- Setup or usage instructions
- Demo video link
- Screenshots
- On Device AI explanation
- Working public links
- Unstop submission completed before the deadline

9.2 Appendix B: Suggested README Outline

Project Name

Short description of what the project does.

Problem

What problem are you solving?

Solution

How does your project solve it?

On Device AI Usage

What runs locally? What model/runtime/device is used?

Tech Stack

Languages, frameworks, models, runtimes, and tools.

Setup and Usage

How can someone run or test it?

Demo and Screenshots

Demo video link and screenshots.

License

Name of the OSI-compliant license used.

9.3 Appendix C: Practical Tips

- Start small and get one feature working first.
- Keep your demo simple and clear.
- Explain what runs locally and what uses cloud support.
- Document setup steps early, not at the last minute.
- Test your repository and video links before submitting.
- A polished small project is better than an unfinished giant one.

9.4 Appendix D: Frequently Asked Questions

What is OSDHack 2026?

OSDHack 2026 is an online open-source hackathon by Open Source Developers Community (OSDC). The theme is On Device AI.

Is OSDHack 2026 online or offline?

OSDHack 2026 is fully online. Registration and submissions happen through Unstop, while official communication and updates happen on Discord.

Will participation certificates be provided?

Yes. Participation certificates will be provided to all valid main hackathon submissions.

What does On Device AI mean?

It means the main AI feature runs locally on a user's device, such as a browser, phone, laptop, desktop, edge device, or embedded board, instead of relying fully on cloud AI inference.

Are there fixed problem statements?

No. You can choose your own idea as long as it fits the On Device AI theme.

Can I use cloud services?

Yes, for support features such as hosting, authentication, storage, databases, deployment, or non-core backend features. The main AI functionality should run locally or on-device.

Do I need special hardware?

No. A browser-based, desktop, laptop, or phone-based project can be a strong submission. Edge and embedded devices are welcome, but not required.

Can I participate solo?

Yes. Solo participation is allowed, and teams can have up to 4 members.

Can I be part of multiple teams?

No. Each participant can be part of only one team.

What do I need to submit?

A public repository link, README, demo video, and screenshots through Unstop before the deadline.

Can I use any Git hosting platform?

Yes. GitHub, GitLab, Codeberg, Bitbucket, or any other public Git hosting platform is allowed.

Does my project need to be open source?

Yes. The project must be fully open source and use an OSI-compliant license.

Can I submit an existing project?

A complete pre-built project should not be submitted as hackathon work. The submitted project should be built during the official hackathon period.

What happens to commits after the deadline?

Only commits made before 15 July 2026, 6:00 PM IST will be considered for judging. Later commits may stay in the repository but will not be evaluated.

How long should the demo video be?

The recommended length is 2 to 5 minutes. There is no strict limit, but short and clear is best.

Are mini-events mandatory?

No. Mini-events are optional and separate from the main hackathon.

Can non-hackathon participants join mini-events?

Yes. Mini-events are open to all. Details will be shared on Discord.

Do mini-events affect the main hackathon score?

No. Mini-event scores do not affect the main hackathon score.

Where will updates be shared?

Discord will be the main place for announcements, support, resources, reminders, mini-event updates, and clarifications. Unstop will be used for registration and final submission.

Where can I ask for help?

Use the official Discord server for help and event-related questions.